

Thai Street Food Café

The complete operator blueprint — recipes, costs, service, P&L

18–22%

TARGET FOOD
COST

\$12–17

AVG ENTRÉE
PRICE

6+2+4

ENTRÉES+DRINKS+DESSERTS

\$29.99

GUIDE PRICE

36

SEATS

\$36

AVG SPEND

\$84,240

EST. MONTHLY
REVENUE

\$42,907

EST. MONTHLY
NET

// WHAT A MICHELIN-TRAINED CHEF SEES IN THAI COOKING

Thai cooking is technically one of the most demanding cuisines in the world. The balance of sweet, sour, salt, heat and umami — achieved simultaneously in a single dish — is not a formula. It is a calibration that happens in real time, in a mortar, over a wok, at temperature. Som tum is not a salad. It is a percussion instrument. The som tum cook bruises, crushes and

builds flavour with pressure and timing. The food cost is 15%. The skill behind it took a decade to develop — and this guide compresses that knowledge into a format you can execute on day one.

// WHAT THIS GUIDE DOES

The moment it clicks is the P&L page. Not the recipes — the numbers. When you see a \$2.18 food cost against a \$13.99 sell price on som tum, something shifts. The dream stops being romantic and starts being a plan. Thai street food is not a trend. It is one of the most commercially durable café formats in the US market.

This guide is the blueprint.

Section 1 — Entrées

TOD MUN PLA

Tod Mun Pla — Thai Fish Cakes

Kaffir lime fish cakes, sweet chili dipping sauce, cucumber relish · Sell: \$12.99 · 8 min · Target FC: 16%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
White fish (cod/tilapia), minced	180g	\$1.44
Red curry paste (house)	20g	\$0.22
Kaffir lime leaves (chiffonade)	4 leaves	\$0.08
Fish sauce	10ml	\$0.04
Egg	1 × 55g	\$0.35
Long beans (sliced thin)	30g	\$0.08
Sweet chili sauce (batch)	40ml	\$0.12
Cucumber relish (batch)	60g	\$0.14
Total cost (6 cakes)		\$2.47

\$2.47

\$12.99

19.0%

\$10.52

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1

Mince fish in a food processor to a smooth paste — not chunky. The smooth paste gives tod mun its characteristic bouncy, dense Q texture. Add curry paste, kaffir lime leaves, fish sauce, egg. Process briefly to combine. Fold in sliced long beans by hand.
- 2

Form into flat discs, 30g each, 1cm thick. Wet hands prevent sticking. The flat disc shape ensures even cooking.
- 3

Shallow fry in oil at 175°C / 347°F for 2–3 minutes per side until deep golden. Internal temp: 70°C / 158°F. Drain briefly. Crispy exterior, springy dense interior.
- 4

Cucumber relish (ajat): rice vinegar + sugar + salt + water, warm to dissolve. Add diced cucumber, shallot, fresh chili, cilantro. Serve sharp and cold to contrast the hot fish cakes.

Chef's Tip: Kaffir lime leaves are irreplaceable — their floral, citrusy intensity is what makes tod mun smell and taste Thai. Buy fresh or frozen from Asian grocery suppliers. Dried kaffir

lime leaves have almost no flavour.

FISH

EGGS

SHELLFISH (fish sauce may contain)

SOM TUM

Som Tum — Green Papaya Salad

Shredded green papaya, chili, lime, fish sauce, peanuts · Sell: \$12.99 · 6 min · Target FC: 14%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Green papaya (shredded)	150g	\$0.54
Thai bird's eye chilies	3–5 pieces	\$0.06
Garlic cloves	2 cloves / 8g	\$0.04
Cherry tomatoes (halved)	40g	\$0.24
Long beans (cut 3cm)	30g	\$0.08
Fish sauce + palm sugar	15ml + 8g	\$0.08
Fresh lime juice	30ml	\$0.12
Roasted peanuts (crushed)	20g	\$0.14
Dried shrimp (optional)	5g	\$0.08
Total cost per serve		\$1.38

\$1.38 \$12.99 10.6% \$11.61

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Som tum is made in a mortar and pestle — non-negotiable. A food processor creates a wet uniform mash. The mortar bruises and crushes ingredients while maintaining textural integrity.
- 2 Pound garlic and chilies first until roughly broken. Add palm sugar, pound to dissolve. Add long beans and tomatoes — pound gently (bruised, not destroyed). Add shredded papaya. Pound and mix simultaneously. Fish sauce and lime juice added last.
- 3 Flavour balance is the entire skill: spicy + sweet + sour + salty must all be present and in balance. Taste after every addition. Adjust with individual components.
- 4 Serve immediately — the papaya releases liquid quickly and the salad becomes soggy within 20 minutes. Transfer from mortar directly to the plate. Scatter crushed peanuts at service.

Chef's Tip: Spice level is the most important guest interaction. Ask every table: "How spicy? Thai-spicy means 5–7 bird's eye chilies. Mild means 1–2." Never assume. Thai bird's eye chilies are among the hottest commercially available chilies.

FISH (fish sauce)

SHELLFISH (dried shrimp)

NUTS (peanuts)

SATAY

Satay — Grilled Chicken Skewers

Turmeric chicken skewers, peanut sauce, ajat · Sell: \$13.99 (4 skewers) · 10 min ·

Target FC: 18%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Chicken thigh (boneless, sliced thin)	160g	\$1.13
Turmeric + coriander + cumin	3g + 3g + 2g	\$0.06
Lemongrass (minced)	10g	\$0.08
Coconut milk + palm sugar	30ml + 5g	\$0.14
Fish sauce	8ml	\$0.03
Peanut sauce (batch)	60ml	\$0.36
Cucumber relish (ajat)	60g	\$0.14
Total cost (4 skewers)		\$1.94

\$1.94 \$13.99 13.9% \$12.05

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Slice chicken thigh thinly — 5mm strips — and thread onto soaked bamboo skewers in a ribbon/wave pattern. This threading keeps the meat flat against the grill for maximum contact and caramelisation.
- 2 Marinade: lemongrass + turmeric + coriander + cumin + coconut milk + palm sugar + fish sauce. Marinate minimum 2 hours. Turmeric gives the golden colour; lemongrass gives the aromatic identity.
- 3 Grill on very hot grill — **220°C / 428°F**. Turn once after 3 minutes. 2–3 minutes more. Internal: **74°C / 165°F**. Brush with remaining coconut milk marinade during grilling for gloss.
- 4 Peanut sauce (batch): fry red curry paste in oil 2 minutes. Add coconut milk, simmer. Add peanut butter, palm sugar, fish sauce, tamarind. Simmer until thick and glossy.

Chef's Tip: Satay is your entry-level item — familiar to guests with minimal Thai experience, beloved by everyone who knows it. It is also your most versatile cross-sell: "Start with the satay while you wait for your pad thai." This framing turns satay into a table-management tool and increases average spend.

POULTRY

NUTS (peanuts)

FISH (fish sauce)

TOM YUM SOUP

Tom Yum Soup

Lemongrass prawn broth, galangal, kaffir lime, mushroom · Sell: \$13.99 · 8 min · Target FC: 18%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Tiger prawns (shell-on, 3 per serve)	120g	\$2.16
Tom yum broth (batch)	350ml	\$0.48
Straw mushrooms / oyster mushrooms	50g	\$0.36
Fresh lime juice	20ml	\$0.08
Fish sauce	10ml	\$0.04

Bird's eye chillies (sliced)

3 pieces

\$0.04

Cilantro + scallion (garnish)

8g + 5g

\$0.06

Total cost per serve

\$3.22

\$3.22

\$13.99

23.0%

\$10.77

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

1

Tom yum broth (large batch — make daily): simmer prawn heads/shells in water 20 minutes. Add bruised lemongrass, sliced galangal (not ginger), kaffir lime leaves, Thai chillies. Simmer 15 minutes. Add fish sauce, lime juice, and nam prik pao (roasted chili paste) for the characteristic red-orange colour and smoky depth.

2

Service: bring broth to a boil. Add mushrooms, cook 2 minutes. Add prawns — cook just until pink and curled, 2–3 minutes maximum. Overcooked prawns in hot soup become rubbery within minutes.

3

Final seasoning: add fresh lime juice and fish sauce after removing from heat. Fresh lime must be added off heat — boiled lime juice loses its bright volatile citrus character.

Chef's Tip: Brief FOH: "The lemongrass pieces and the round ginger-like pieces are for flavour only — just move them to the side." This prevents the complaint "I bit into something hard and inedible."

SHELLFISH (prawns)

FISH (fish sauce, prawn stock)

MIANG KHAM

Miang Kham — Leaf Wraps

Wild betel leaves, toasted coconut, shrimp, ginger, peanut, lime · Sell: \$11.99 · 5 min · Target FC: 14%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Wild betel / spinach leaves (sub)	8 leaves	\$0.24
Toasted shredded coconut	20g	\$0.12
Dried shrimp	10g	\$0.16
Fresh ginger (tiny dice)	15g	\$0.06
Shallot (tiny dice)	15g	\$0.04
Lime (quartered, tiny)	¼ lime	\$0.05
Roasted peanuts	15g	\$0.11
Miang sauce (batch)	30ml	\$0.16
Total cost (8 pieces)		\$0.94

\$0.94

\$11.99

7.8%

\$11.05

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

1

Miang kham is one of the great Thai one-bite experiences. Miang sauce: palm sugar + fish sauce + shrimp paste + water + grated coconut, cooked to a thick, dark, intensely sweet-savoury sauce. This sauce is the flavour anchor.

2

Each component is placed in its own small pile on the presentation board: coconut, dried

shrimp, ginger, shallot, peanuts, tiny lime wedges. The guest assembles their own wrap — a small amount of each ingredient in a leaf, drizzled with miang sauce, folded and eaten whole.

- 3 The explosion of flavours in one bite — sweet, sour, spicy, salty, crunchy — is one of the most complex single bites in Southeast Asian cuisine. Brief every table on the assembly — it is part of the experience.

Chef's Tip: If wild betel leaves are unavailable, use large spinach leaves or cha-plu leaves. The leaf is just the delivery mechanism — the components and miang sauce are the non-negotiables.

SHELLFISH (dried shrimp) FISH (fish sauce, shrimp paste) NUTS (peanuts)

GAI HOR BAI TOEY

Gai Hor Bai Toey — Pandan Chicken

Pandan-wrapped chicken parcels, sesame soy dip · Sell: \$12.99 (4 pieces) · 10 min · Target FC: 16%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Chicken thigh (diced 2cm)	160g	\$1.13
Pandan leaves (fresh/frozen)	8 long leaves	\$0.16
Oyster sauce + soy + sesame oil	10ml + 5ml + 3ml	\$0.10
Garlic + coriander root	5g + 3g	\$0.04
Sesame soy dipping sauce	30ml	\$0.10
Total cost (4 parcels)		\$1.53

\$1.53 \$12.99 11.8% \$11.46

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Marinate diced chicken in oyster sauce, soy, sesame oil, pounded garlic and coriander root. Rest 2 hours. Coriander root is a Thai pantry essential — its flavour is earthier and more intense than the leaf.
- 2 Wrap each chicken piece in a pandan leaf — fold into a neat package and secure with a toothpick if needed. The pandan perfumes the chicken subtly, creates a dramatic presentation, and protects the chicken from direct oil contact.
- 3 Deep fry at 175°C / 347°F for 5–6 minutes until the pandan leaf is dark green and slightly charred at the edges and the chicken is cooked through. The glossy green parcels look elegant and distinctive.

Chef's Tip: Pandan chicken is your most visually distinctive appetiser — the deep green glossy parcels look elegant and unusual. Guests invariably ask what they are when they see them at a neighbouring table. This is your silent marketing item. Always run it and place it at visible tables.

POULTRY FISH (oyster sauce) SESAME GLUTEN (oyster/soy sauce)

Section 2 — Mains

PAD THAI

Pad Thai

Rice noodles, egg, bean sprouts, tamarind, peanuts · Sell: \$17.99 · 8 min · Target FC: 18%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Rice noodles (3mm, soaked)	100g dry	\$0.30
Shrimp (peeled) or tofu	80g	\$1.44
Eggs	2 × 55g	\$0.70
Pad thai sauce (batch)	40ml	\$0.20
Bean sprouts	50g	\$0.10
Dried shrimp + preserved radish	5g + 10g	\$0.12
Shallots (sliced)	15g	\$0.04
Roasted peanuts (crushed)	20g	\$0.14
Lime wedge + chili flakes + scallion	—	\$0.08
Total cost per serve		\$3.12

\$3.12 \$17.99 17.3% \$14.87

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Pad thai sauce (batch): tamarind paste + fish sauce + palm sugar (3:2:2 ratio). Simmer until palm sugar dissolves. Balance simultaneously sour (tamarind), salty (fish sauce), sweet (palm sugar). Jarred sauce is an inferior shortcut.
- 2 Wok hei is the goal. Use maximum heat. Stir-fry shallots, dried shrimp, preserved radish briefly. Push to side. Add shrimp, cook 60 seconds. Push to side. Add noodles and sauce — toss rapidly. Push everything to side, crack eggs into the empty pan centre, scramble partially, fold through noodles.
- 3 Add bean sprouts at the last 30 seconds — they should still have crunch. Toss once more. Plate immediately. The entire cook takes 4–5 minutes maximum.
- 4 Serve with condiment tray: chili flakes, fish sauce, white sugar, white vinegar. This is standard Thai restaurant service — it communicates authenticity and lets guests season to their own taste.

Chef's Tip: One wok, one portion at a time. Pad thai made in batches has no wok hei — the temperature drops and everything steams. Your wok station should produce one pad thai every 5 minutes during peak service.

SHELLFISH (shrimp)

FISH (fish sauce, dried shrimp)

EGGS

NUTS (peanuts)

GAENG KEOW WAN

Green Curry — Gaeng Keow Wan

House green curry paste, chicken, Thai eggplant, coconut milk · Sell: \$18.99 · 12 min · Target FC: 20%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Chicken thigh (sliced)	160g	\$1.13
Green curry paste (house)	30g	\$0.36
Coconut milk (full fat)	250ml	\$0.75
Thai eggplant (quartered)	60g	\$0.24
Fish sauce + palm sugar	15ml + 8g	\$0.08
Kaffir lime leaves (torn)	4 leaves	\$0.08
Thai basil	10g	\$0.08
Jasmine rice (side)	180g cooked	\$0.32
Total cost per serve		\$3.04

\$3.04 \$18.99 16.0% \$15.95

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 House green curry paste (batch — 10+ portions): pound in mortar — green bird's eye chillies, lemongrass, galangal, kaffir lime zest, coriander root, garlic, shallot, shrimp paste, cumin, coriander seeds, white pepper. The mortar releases volatile oils that blending does not.
- 2 Fry curry paste in the coconut cream (top layer of unshaken coconut milk) over medium heat until fragrant and oil separates (3–4 minutes). "Cracking the coconut cream" is essential — un-fried paste produces a flat curry.
- 3 Add remaining coconut milk, bring to simmer. Add chicken and eggplant. Cook 8–10 minutes until chicken is cooked through (**74°C / 165°F**) and eggplant is tender. Season with fish sauce and palm sugar. Add torn kaffir lime leaves and Thai basil off heat.

Chef's Tip: A house-made paste is vivid emerald green. Jarred paste is olive drab. The colour difference is visible from across the room and justifies the price premium to any guest who notices.

POULTRY

FISH (fish sauce, shrimp paste)

SHELLFISH (shrimp paste)

MASSAMAN CURRY

Massaman Curry

Slow-braised beef, potato, peanut, tamarind, coconut · Sell: \$19.99 · 10 min service (batch) · Target FC: 22%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Beef chuck (braised, batch)	180g cooked	\$2.61
Massaman paste (batch)	25g	\$0.28
Coconut milk (full fat)	200ml	\$0.60
Potato (cubed)	80g	\$0.14
Roasted peanuts	20g	\$0.14
Tamarind paste + palm sugar	10g + 8g	\$0.10
Fish sauce	10ml	\$0.04

Jasmine rice180g cooked\$0.32

Total cost per serve\$4.23

\$4.23 \$19.99 21.2% \$15.76

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1

Massaman is a slow-cook curry — it cannot be made to order. Braise beef chuck (2cm cubes) in massaman paste + coconut milk + water at

150°C / 302°F

 for 2.5–3 hours until completely tender. Extended braising dissolves connective tissue into gelatin, creating the silky sauce.
- 2

Massaman paste: dried red chillies, roasted shallots, roasted garlic, lemongrass, galangal, coriander seeds, cumin, cloves, cinnamon, nutmeg, shrimp paste. The warm spice profile (cloves, cinnamon, nutmeg) reflects the Muslim-influenced Southern Thai heritage.
- 3

Add potatoes for the final 30 minutes — they absorb the curry sauce deeply. Add peanuts. Adjust: tamarind for acidity, palm sugar for sweetness, fish sauce for salt. Massaman should be rich, slightly sweet, gently spiced, and deeply savoury.

Chef's Tip: Massaman was ranked the world's best food by CNN Travel in 2011. Use this: "This is the curry CNN called the best food in the world." It is a genuine reference and frames the dish as worth ordering.

BEEF

FISH (fish sauce, shrimp paste)

NUTS (peanuts)

PAD KRA PAO

Pad Kra Pao — Thai Basil Stir-Fry

Minced pork, holy basil, fish sauce, fried egg, jasmine rice · Sell: \$15.99 · 8 min
· Target FC: 16%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Minced pork (or chicken)	180g	\$1.26
Holy basil (Thai, not sweet)	15g	\$0.10
Garlic + bird's eye chili (minced)	10g + 5 chillies	\$0.08
Oyster sauce + soy + fish sauce	15ml + 5ml + 5ml	\$0.12
Dark soy sauce + sugar	3ml + 3g	\$0.02
Fried egg (crispy edges)	1 × 55g	\$0.35
Jasmine rice	180g cooked	\$0.32

Total cost per serve\$2.25

\$2.25 \$15.99 14.1% \$13.74

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1

Pound garlic and bird's eye chillies coarsely in a mortar. Heat wok to maximum. Oil. Add garlic-chili paste — cook 30 seconds, stirring rapidly (do not burn the garlic).
- 2

Add minced pork — stir-fry on maximum heat, breaking up clumps. Cook until fully cooked and beginning to caramelise at the edges. Add oyster sauce, soy, fish sauce, dark soy, sugar. Stir to coat.

- 3 Add holy basil at the very last moment — toss 3–4 times and immediately plate. Holy basil loses its distinctive peppery, anise-like flavour within 20 seconds of heat exposure.
- 4 The fried egg: deep fry in about 1cm of hot oil — pour oil over the top while frying to cook the white while edges crisp and blister. When the runny yolk breaks over the basil pork, it creates a sauce.

Chef's Tip: Pad kra pao is the most-eaten dish in Thailand — the national comfort food. Holy basil (kra pao) is not the same as sweet Italian basil. Source holy basil from Asian grocers or grow it yourself. This dish made with sweet basil is not pad kra pao.

PORK FISH (fish sauce) EGGS GLUTEN (oyster/soy)

KHAO MAN GAI

Khao Man Gai — Poached Chicken Rice

Silky poached chicken, ginger-garlic rice, clear broth, dipping sauces · Sell: \$16.99
· 8 min service (batch) · Target FC: 18%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Chicken breast (poached)	160g	\$1.44
Chicken fat rice (cooked in stock)	180g cooked	\$0.36
Clear chicken broth (side)	150ml	\$0.18
Ginger-garlic dipping sauce	30ml	\$0.14
Fermented soybean sauce	15ml	\$0.08
Cucumber (sliced)	40g	\$0.08
Cilantro + fried garlic	5g + 3g	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$2.34

\$2.34 \$16.99 13.8% \$14.65

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Poach whole chicken breasts in aromatic stock (ginger, garlic, lemongrass, salt) at **82°C / 180°F** — below a boil. Boiling causes proteins to contract violently, producing tough stringy chicken. Sub-boil gentle poaching produces silky, juicy chicken.
- 2 Chicken fat rice: render chicken fat from the poaching liquid surface with garlic and ginger. Toast jasmine rice in this fat 2 minutes. Cook in poaching stock 1:1.5 ratio. The rice absorbs the poaching liquid's flavour — savoury, silky, deeply complex.
- 3 Slice chicken cold (against the grain). Arrange on rice. Serve with clear broth, ginger-garlic sauce, fermented soybean sauce, cucumber slices, cilantro, fried garlic. The multiple dipping sauces are part of the eating ritual.

Chef's Tip: Khao man gai is the most underrepresented great dish in Thai restaurants outside Thailand. In Bangkok, entire restaurants serve only this dish all day. Guests who have eaten it in Thailand will specifically seek it out.

POULTRY FISH (soy sauce) SESAME GLUTEN (soy)

TOM KHA GAI

Tom Kha Gai — Coconut Galangal Soup

Chicken in coconut broth, galangal, lemongrass, mushroom · Sell: \$14.99 · 10 min · Target FC: 16%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Chicken thigh (sliced)	120g	\$0.85
Coconut milk (full fat)	300ml	\$0.90
Galangal (sliced rounds)	20g	\$0.12
Lemongrass (bruised, sliced)	2 stalks	\$0.08
Kaffir lime leaves	4 leaves	\$0.08
Oyster mushrooms	50g	\$0.36
Fish sauce + lime juice	15ml + 20ml	\$0.10
Bird's eye chili + cilantro	2 + 8g	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$2.55

\$2.55 \$14.99 17.0% \$12.44

COST / SERVE SELL PRICE FOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Bring coconut milk to a gentle simmer — never boil coconut milk rapidly, it separates. Add galangal, lemongrass, kaffir lime leaves. Simmer 5 minutes to infuse. Add chicken and mushrooms. Cook 6–8 minutes at a gentle simmer. Internal chicken: 74°C / 165°F.
- 2 Season with fish sauce. Add fresh lime juice off the heat. The soup should be creamy, mildly spicy, intensely aromatic, with a gentle sweetness balanced by lime tartness and fish sauce depth.
- 3 Finish with torn cilantro and sliced bird's eye chili. Brief FOH: the galangal, lemongrass, and kaffir lime are aromatics — there to flavour and present, not to eat.

Chef's Tip: Tom kha and tom yum are the two essential Thai soups — offer both. Tom yum is spicy-sour; tom kha is creamy-aromatic. Guests uncertain about spice often choose tom kha — it is the gentler introduction to Thai broth.

POULTRY

FISH (fish sauce)

PAD SEE EW

Pad See Ew — Wide Noodle Stir-Fry

Wide rice noodles, soy, Chinese broccoli, egg, your choice of protein · Sell: \$16.99 · 8 min · Target FC: 18%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Fresh wide rice noodles (sen yai)	180g	\$0.72
Chicken thigh (sliced)	120g	\$0.85
Chinese broccoli (gai lan)	80g	\$0.32

Eggs2 × 55g\$0.70

Dark soy + light soy + oyster sauce15ml + 5ml + 10ml\$0.14

Sugar + white pepper5g + 1g\$0.02

Total cost per serve\$2.75

\$2.75\$16.9916.2%\$14.24

COST / SERVESELL PRICEFOOD COST%CONTRIBUTION

1

Pad see ew requires the hottest possible wok heat for the characteristic charred soy flavour. Separate fresh wide rice noodles gently by hand before cooking — they clump in the package and will tear if not handled carefully.

2

Sear chicken in screaming-hot wok. Add noodles — press flat against the wok surface with a spatula and leave 30 seconds to char. The dark soy caramelises against the hot wok, creating charred slightly bitter sweetness that defines pad see ew. Then toss. Add sauces and sugar.

3

Push aside, scramble eggs in the wok centre, fold through noodles. Add gai lan stems (1 minute), then leaves (30 seconds). Season with white pepper. Chinese broccoli should be bright green with crunch. Serve immediately.

Chef's Tip: The dark caramelised colour — almost black in spots — is the visual signal of quality. A pale pad see ew was not cooked on a hot enough wok. Get the heat right and the colour follows.

POULTRY

EGGS

FISH (oyster sauce)

GLUTEN (soy)

KHAO PAD

Khao Pad — Thai Fried Rice

Day-old jasmine rice, egg, tomato, scallion, fish sauce, lime · Sell: \$14.99 · 6 min · Target FC: 14%

IngredientWeightCost

Day-old jasmine rice220g cooked\$0.40

Eggs2 × 55g\$0.70

Protein choice (shrimp/chicken/tofu)80g\$1.00

Tomato (wedged)40g\$0.14

White onion30g\$0.06

Fish sauce + soy sauce10ml + 5ml\$0.06

Cucumber + lime + scallion30g + wedge + 8g\$0.10

Total cost per serve\$2.46

\$2.46\$14.9916.4%\$12.53

COST / SERVESELL PRICEFOOD COST%CONTRIBUTION

1

Thai fried rice is lighter and less soy-forward than Chinese fried rice — the seasonings are fish sauce + a little soy + a touch of sugar. The character is lighter and more fragrant. Day-old jasmine rice is mandatory — dry, slightly sticky texture fries without clumping.

2

Wok hot, oil, protein first, set aside. Oil again, crack eggs directly into wok, scramble briefly

then add rice immediately — the semi-liquid egg coats the rice grains as they fry together. Fish sauce and soy added. Toss rapidly for 2 minutes over maximum heat.

- 3 Add tomato wedges last — just 30 seconds. Thai fried rice always has tomato for brightness and acidity. Return protein. Toss once. Serve with fresh cucumber slices, lime wedge, and a small side of fish sauce with chili.

Chef's Tip: Khao pad is your fastest high-margin item — 6 minutes, \$2.46 food cost, \$14.99 sell price. It is also the dish that converts uncertain guests into regulars. Run it as "khao pad with your choice of protein" to maximise inclusivity and reduce ordering friction.

EGGS FISH (fish sauce) GLUTEN (soy)

Section 3 — Desserts

KHAO NIEW MAMUANG

Mango Sticky Rice — Khao Niew Mamuang

Coconut sticky rice, fresh mango, coconut cream sauce · Sell: \$9.99 · 3 min service (batch) · Target FC: 16%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Glutinous rice (cooked, coconut)	120g cooked	\$0.36
Ripe mango (Nam Dok Mai preferred)	150g sliced	\$0.84
Coconut cream sauce (batch)	60ml	\$0.36
Toasted sesame seeds	3g	\$0.04
Mung beans (toasted, optional)	5g	\$0.04
Total cost per serve		\$1.64

\$1.64 \$9.99 16.4% \$8.35
COST / SERVESELL PRICEFOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Coconut sticky rice (batch): soak glutinous rice 4 hours. Steam 25–30 minutes until cooked through and translucent. While hot, mix with warm coconut milk + sugar + salt. The hot rice absorbs the coconut milk completely. Cover and rest 20 minutes.
- 2 Coconut cream sauce (batch): reduce coconut cream + sugar + salt + a little rice flour to a slightly thickened, glossy sauce. This sauce adds richness and makes the dish immediately photographable.
- 3 Plate: mold sticky rice into a neat cylinder or dome. Slice mango alongside (Nam Dok Mai preferred — its sweetness and smooth texture are superior). Pour coconut cream sauce over rice. Scatter sesame seeds.

Chef's Tip: Mango sticky rice is one of the top 5 most Instagrammed Thai dishes globally. The golden mango against white coconut rice with cream sauce is inherently photogenic. Specify the mango variety when it is Nam Dok Mai — the specificity signals quality.

TREE NUTS (coconut)

Tub Tim Grob — Water Chestnuts in Coconut Milk

Rubied water chestnuts, jasmine coconut milk, crushed ice · Sell: \$7.99 · 3 min service (batch) · Target FC: 12%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Water chestnuts (diced, coated)	80g	\$0.40
Tapioca starch + red food colouring	30g + trace	\$0.08
Sweetened coconut milk (batch)	200ml	\$0.48
Crushed ice	100g	\$0.02
Jackfruit (canned, shredded)	20g	\$0.12
Total cost per serve		\$1.10

\$1.10 \$7.99 13.8% \$6.89

COST / SERVESELL PRICEFOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Toss diced water chestnuts in red food colouring until deeply stained. Coat thoroughly in tapioca starch. Blanch in boiling water 1–2 minutes — the tapioca coating turns translucent and glossy, creating the characteristic "jewel" effect (tub tim = rubies). The water chestnut inside remains crunchy.
- 2 Sweetened coconut milk: warm coconut milk with sugar, pandan leaf, and a pinch of salt. The pandan infusion gives a green-tinged jasmine-floral note. Strain, chill completely. Must be served cold — this is an iced dessert.
- 3 Assemble: crushed ice in a bowl or glass. Add water chestnut rubies. Pour cold coconut milk over. Add shredded jackfruit. The colour from the water chestnuts bleeds beautifully into the coconut milk, creating a pink-tinged visually striking presentation.

Chef's Tip: Tub tim grob is uniquely Thai — there is no equivalent in any other cuisine. Describe it as "water chestnuts coated in translucent tapioca and served in iced coconut milk" — the description alone is intriguing enough to convert orders.

TREE NUTS (coconut)

KLUAY TOD

Kluay Tod — Fried Banana

Crispy coconut-battered banana, coconut ice cream, palm sugar caramel · Sell: \$8.99 · 6 min · Target FC: 14%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Lady finger or Cavendish banana	2 pieces / 120g	\$0.24
Coconut batter (rice flour + coconut + sesame)	60g	\$0.16
Coconut ice cream (scoop)	60ml	\$0.48
Palm sugar caramel (batch)	30ml	\$0.18
Toasted sesame + coconut flakes	3g + 3g	\$0.06

Total cost per serve

\$1.12

\$1.12

\$8.99

12.5%

\$7.87

COST / SERVESELL PRICEFOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1

Coconut batter: rice flour + plain flour (50:50) + desiccated coconut + sesame seeds + sugar + cold water + coconut milk. Mix to a smooth, slightly thick batter. The coconut and sesame create a crunchy, nutty, golden exterior.
- 2

Halve bananas lengthwise. Coat in batter. Fry at

175°C / 347°F

 for 3–4 minutes until golden and crispy. The banana inside should be hot, soft, and caramelising at the edges. Serve immediately — fried banana loses crispiness within 4 minutes.
- 3

Plate: fried banana, scoop of coconut ice cream alongside (cold against hot is the contrast), drizzle palm sugar caramel over everything, scatter toasted coconut flakes and sesame. The melting ice cream and warm caramel create a sauce as the dessert is eaten.

Chef's Tip:

Price it just under \$10 so the decision is easy. Pre-sell it at the main course stage: "We do a fried banana with coconut ice cream — 6 minutes if you want it at the end." Almost everyone says yes.

GLUTEN (flour)

SESAME

TREE NUTS (coconut)

DAIRY (ice cream)

SANGKAYA

Sangkaya — Thai Egg Custard

Steamed pandan coconut custard, served warm in a pumpkin · Sell: \$8.99 · 3 min service (batch, steam 40 min) · Target FC: 12%

Ingredient	Weight	Cost
Mini pumpkin (kabocha)	1 × 200g	\$0.60
Eggs	3 × 55g	\$1.05
Coconut milk	100ml	\$0.30
Palm sugar	40g	\$0.16
Pandan juice (fresh blended)	15ml	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$2.17

\$2.17

\$8.99

24.1%

\$6.82

COST / SERVESELL PRICEFOOD COST %CONTRIBUTION

- 1

Cut the top off small kabocha pumpkins, scoop out seeds. Custard: whisk eggs + coconut milk + palm sugar + pandan juice (fresh pandan leaves blended with water, strained) until smooth. The pandan juice gives the custard its emerald green colour and jasmine fragrance.
- 2

Pour custard into the hollowed pumpkin. Replace lid. Steam at medium heat for 35–40 minutes until custard is fully set and pumpkin flesh is cooked through. Cool slightly. Can be made 1–2 days ahead. Reheat gently (steamer, 10 minutes) before service.
- 3

Slice the pumpkin into wedges — the custard and pumpkin flesh together form the dessert. Each wedge shows the green custard against the orange pumpkin — a visually stunning cross-section.

Chef's Tip:

Sangkaya in pumpkin is one of the most visually dramatic Thai desserts. The reveal when you slice through a whole mini pumpkin to show the green custard inside is

genuinely impressive — do it at the pass where guests can see if possible.

EGGS

TREE NUTS (coconut)

Section 4 — Drinks Menu

Thai Iced Tea — Cha Yen

\$5.99 · Cost \$0.54 · FC 9.0%

Strongly brewed Thai tea with anise, sweetened with condensed milk, served over ice with an evaporated milk pour. The vivid orange colour and sweet slightly spiced flavour is one of the most recognisable drinks in Asian food culture globally.

Young Coconut Water

\$6.99 · Cost \$1.40 · FC 20.0%

Fresh young coconut, served with a straw in the coconut. Naturally sweet, hydrating, electrolyte-rich. The coconut itself is the presentation — serve it as is. The visual of a whole coconut on the table communicates freshness and exotic appeal immediately.

Lemongrass Ginger Cooler

\$5.99 · Cost \$0.48 · FC 8.0%

Cold-steeped lemongrass + ginger syrup, served over ice with a lemongrass stalk garnish. Bright, citrusy, slightly spicy, non-alcoholic. The lemongrass stalk as the straw is both functional and visually distinctive. A strong social media photo every single time.

Pandan Coconut Latte

\$6.50 · Cost \$0.72 · FC 11.1%

Fresh pandan extract in warm water, served as a latte with steamed coconut milk foam. Vivid green, fragrant, slightly sweet. Thai café culture has elevated pandan to the same status as matcha in the West. Instagram-ready on every serve.

Singha Beer

\$7.99 · Cost \$1.60 · FC 20.0%

The classic Thai lager. Crisp, light, pairs perfectly with spicy food. Serve cold in the bottle with a frosted glass. Singha and Chang are cultural markers — guests who know Thailand will order them by name. The bottle on the table signals authenticity.

Thai Basil Mojito

\$12.99 · Cost \$1.92 · FC 14.8%

White rum, holy basil, lime, chili sugar, soda water. The peppery bite of holy basil replaces mint — the result is more complex and distinctly Thai. Muddle gently — holy basil is fragile. Signature cocktail that tells the menu's story in one glass.

Tamarind Whisky Sour

\$13.99 · Cost \$2.24 · FC 16.0%

Bourbon, house tamarind syrup, lime juice, egg white. Shaken hard — egg white creates a thick silky foam. Tamarind replaces classic simple syrup, adding complex sour-sweet depth that bourbon handles beautifully. One of the best Thai-fusion cocktails possible.

Butterfly Pea Flower Tea

\$5.99 · Cost \$0.40 · FC 6.7%

Cold-steeped butterfly pea flower tea — naturally vivid indigo blue. When the guest squeezes the lime wedge in, the acid turns the drink from blue to violet-purple before their eyes. Zero alcohol, zero caffeine, 100% visual impact. Sell this at every table.

Section 5 — Service Training Module

SCRIPT 1 — THE TEA OPENING

"Can I get you a Thai iced tea while you look at the menu? We brew it strong with the traditional Thai tea leaves — it's sweet, slightly spiced, orange. Or the butterfly pea flower tea — it's blue until you put lime in it and it turns purple. \$5.99 each."

Why it works: The butterfly pea tea colour change is the most reliably effective drink sell in Thai food. The chemistry demo converts almost every table that hears it.

SCRIPT 2 — THE SPICE CONVERSATION

"Before I take your order — how spicy do you like things? Thai spicy means bird's eye chilies, which are legitimately hot. Medium means 2–3. Thai means 5–7. I always ask because the gap between medium and Thai is significant."

Why it works: Proactive spice management prevents complaints, creates a collaborative dynamic, and demonstrates that you know your product. Guests who feel informed don't complain even if it's spicier than expected.

SCRIPT 3 — THE SOM TUM MORTAR

"The som tum is made in the mortar — we make each one fresh to order. 6 minutes. The heat level is completely adjustable. \$12.99 and it's probably the most flavourful \$13 you'll spend today."

Why it works: The mortar detail communicates authenticity immediately. "Made fresh to order" is both honest and a quality signal. "Most flavourful \$13 you'll spend today" is a confident, memorable line.

SCRIPT 4 — THE MASSAMAN STORY

"The massaman — CNN called it the best food in the world a few years back. It's a slow-braised beef curry, Southern Thai, Muslim-influenced, so it has warm spices — cloves, cinnamon, nutmeg — rather than just chili heat. It's not aggressively spicy. \$19.99 with jasmine rice."

Why it works: The CNN reference is a genuine, memorable fact. Explaining the Muslim Southern Thai influence adds cultural depth. "Not aggressively spicy" removes the barrier for spice-uncertain guests.

SCRIPT 5 — THE FRIED BANANA PRE-SELL

"One thing worth knowing — the fried banana with coconut ice cream is 6 minutes if you want it at the end. I'll put it on when I bring your mains so it times right. \$8.99. The batter has coconut and sesame in it — it's not like a funfair doughnut."

Why it works: Pre-ordering removes the "too full" barrier. The coconut-sesame batter detail distinguishes it from cheap fried desserts. Timing it with the mains is a genuine service act that guests appreciate.

Table Timing Guide

Time	Action
	Welcome and seat. Butterfly pea tea or Thai iced tea pitch immediately (Script 1). Small bowl of

0:00	prawn crackers — free, \$0.15, signals hospitality, Thai restaurant standard.
1:30	Spice conversation (Script 2) before they order anything. Drink order taken.
4:00	Full food order. Scripts 3, 4 as relevant. Fried banana pre-sell (Script 5). Note dietary requirements — fish sauce is in almost every dish.
10:00	Entrées arrive. Brief introduction: "The satay peanut sauce — dip the cucumber relish too, not just the skewers." One tip per dish that improves the eating experience.
20:00	Mains arrive. Place condiment tray: fish sauce + chili flakes + sugar + white vinegar. Brief: "Season to your taste — these are how every Thai restaurant in Bangkok serves it."
30:00	Dessert prompt — mango sticky rice, tub tim grob, sangkaya all instant. Fried banana 6 min (already fired if pre-sold). Thai iced tea refill offered.
45:00	Bill. "Come back on a weekend — we sometimes run regional Thai specials." Creates return intent and communicates depth of knowledge.

Complaint Handling

COMPLAINT — TOO SPICY

"I'm sorry about that — I should have been clearer on the spice scale. Let me bring you some jasmine rice to temper it, and I'll have the kitchen make you a fresh one at a lower level. That's on us."

COMPLAINT — GALANGAL/LEMONGRASS IN SOUP

"Those pieces are the aromatics — they're there to flavour the broth, not to eat. I should have mentioned that when the soup arrived. My apologies. Just move them to the side — the broth and everything else is absolutely for eating."

UPSELL — BEVERAGE TOP-UP

"Can I get you another Thai iced tea? The spice in the green curry is going to build — having something cold and sweet helps balance it. Or I can bring you the coconut water — it's the most hydrating thing we have."

Section 6 — 8-Hour Kitchen Prep Flow

Time	Cook 1 (Head Cook)	Cook 2 (Line Cook)	Steward
07:00–07:30	Temp check all units — fridge must read 1–4°C. Start tom yum broth — simmer aromatics 30 min. Taste yesterday's massaman curry and adjust seasoning. Check curry paste freshness and quantity.	Set up wok stations. Soak rice noodles for pad thai. Pre-soak glutinous rice (if not done overnight). Check day-old rice for khao pad — dry enough? Portion fish cake mixture from cold storage.	Sanitise all surfaces. Brew Thai iced tea base (strong, hot — cool and refrigerate). Prepare lemongrass ginger syrup batch. Steep butterfly pea flower tea cold. Slice and juice limes for full service.
07:30–09:00	Make green and red curry paste batches if running low — pound in mortar, no shortcuts. Taste against previous batch. Prepare miang kham sauce. Check satay marinades and set up grill station. Steam sangkaya for service.	Cook coconut sticky rice (steam 30 min). Make pad thai sauce batch. Prep all satay skewers. Shred green papaya for som tum — prep just before service as it oxidises. Slice and portion all proteins.	Prepare ajat (cucumber relish) for tod mun and satay. Make peanut sauce batch. Portion mango sticky rice components. Check ice supply for cold drinks service. Set up condiment trays for all tables.
09:00–11:00 Breakfast	Run the pass. Fire tod mun pla (8 min). Satay grill to order (10 min). Monitor tom yum broth	Executes all entrées to order. Som tum made to order in mortar — confirm spice level with server	Thai iced tea on every table from opening. Butterfly pea tea demo at every table: "Squeeze the lime and watch

/ Early	holding temperature — maintain ≥74°C .	before making. Miang kham assembled to order at pass.	it change colour." Push this at every sitting — it converts.
11:00–14:30 Lunch Push	Full wok push. Pad thai: one portion per wok, maximum heat, 4–5 min. Pad kra pao (8 min). Pad see ew (8 min). Massaman reheated gently. Green curry to order (12 min).	Khao man gai — slice to order and assemble. Khao pad (6 min). Tom kha gai (10 min). Fried banana to order (6 min — pre-sell with every main course for timing).	Full service speed. Singha beer suggested with all spicy dishes. Pre-sell desserts: mango sticky rice (instant), tub tim grob (instant), sangkaya (instant), fried banana (6 min). Thai iced tea refills every 15 min.
14:30–17:00 Break / Dinner Prep	Reduce all curry bases, cool rapidly. Store curry pastes airtight. Restock proteins. Write dinner prep additions based on lunch volume. Rest 30–40 min.	Break down lunch wok station. Clean and season woks. Store day-old rice for tomorrow's khao pad. Drain noodle soak water and refrigerate. Begin dinner protein prep.	Full clean between services. Restock drinks, ice, condiment trays. Brew fresh Thai iced tea batch for dinner service. Check fridge temps — log in food safety book.
17:00–21:30 Dinner Service	Full dinner service — same wok protocols. Monitor all broth temps. Massaman reheated from second batch. Dessert pass. Last order management and portion tracking.	Entrées + mains execution. Dinner tends toward larger tables — batch where safe. Maintain one-portion pad thai rule without compromise. Brief FOH on 86'd items as they go.	Dinner beverage service — cocktails, beer, Thai teas. Dessert pre-sells. Monitor floor pacing with FOH team. Final checks: fridge temps, waste log, mise en place reset for morning.
21:30–22:00 Close	Final fridge temp log — all units 1–4°C . Secure all raw proteins. Write tomorrow's full prep list based on today's covers. Initial curry paste for overnight marinating if needed.	Full wok and station breakdown. Season woks with oil before racking. Label and date all stored prep. Drain noodle water, refrigerate portioned proteins.	Deep clean all surfaces. Empty and sanitise ice bins. Set butterfly pea tea to steep overnight. Prep Thai iced tea base ready for 7am. Final bin and floor. Lock refrigeration log.

Section 7 — Financial Model & P&L

Based on 80-seat venue, 2 services/day, 6 days/week · US market pricing 2025

Service	Covers	Avg Spend	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
Lunch (11am–3pm)	80	\$38	\$3,040	\$18,240	\$79,040
Dinner (5:30pm–9:30pm)	64	\$52	\$3,328	\$19,968	\$86,528
Beverage Mix (1.8 drinks/guest)	144 guests	\$8.50	\$1,224	\$7,344	\$31,824
TOTAL REVENUE	144 covers/day	—	\$7,592	\$45,552	\$197,392

Cost Category	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
Food & Beverage Cost (20%)	\$1,518	\$9,110	\$39,478
Labour — HC + LC + Steward + FOH ×3 (30%)	\$2,278	\$13,666	\$59,218
Rent + Utilities + Misc (16%)	\$1,215	\$7,288	\$31,583
Total Costs	\$5,011	\$30,064	\$130,279
NET PROFIT (est.)	\$2,581	\$15,488	\$67,113

Food cost target: 18–22% · Labour: 28–32% · Overheads: 15–18% · Net margin target: 18–22%

3-Month Ramp: Month 1 (55% capacity) ~\$25,000 net · Month 2 (75%) ~\$41,000 net · Month 3 (100%) ~\$67,113 net · Break-even requires ~\$5,000/day revenue across both services. The beverage mix is critical — target 1.8 drinks per guest across both services to hit these numbers.

Section 8 — Food Safety & Allergens

Critical Temperature Points

Item	Target	Action if Out of Range
Refrigeration (all units)	1-4°C / 34-39°F	Log, correct immediately. Do not use ingredients held above 4°C for over 2 hours.
Poultry (chicken) – cooked through	≥74°C / 165°F	Probe before plating. Return to heat if not reached. No exceptions.
Beef (massaman braising)	≥74°C / 165°F internal	Braise minimum 2.5 hrs at 150°C / 302°F. Probe batch before service.
Fish / seafood – prawns, fish cakes	≥63°C / 145°F	Prawns: pink and curled, max 3 min in hot broth. Fish cake: probe centre.
Deep fry oil temperature	175°C / 347°F	Check with thermometer every 45 min during service. Change oil if dark or smoking low.
Broth / hot-hold (tom yum, tom kha)	≥74°C / 165°F	Monitor every 30 min on the pass. Do not hold below 63°C.
Rapid cool (curries, broths)	From 74°C → 4°C in <2 hours	Use ice bath + shallow containers. Never cool large volumes in deep pots at room temp.

Log all fridge temps at 07:00 (open) and 21:30–22:00 (close). Keep logs on-site for minimum 90 days. Report any unit failure to management immediately — do not serve product from a failed unit.

Allergen Reference

Fish sauce is present in **almost every dish** on this menu. Guests requesting vegetarian or fish-free must be flagged to the kitchen — specific substitutions required. When in doubt, confirm with the head cook before serving.

Dish	Allergens Present
Tod Mun Pla – Fish Cakes	FISH EGGS SHELLFISH (fish sauce may contain)
Som Tum – Green Papaya Salad	FISH (fish sauce) SHELLFISH (dried shrimp) NUTS (peanuts)
Satay – Chicken Skewers	POULTRY NUTS (peanuts) FISH (fish sauce)
Tom Yum Goong – Prawn Soup	SHELLFISH (prawns) FISH (fish sauce, prawn stock)

Miang Kham – Betel
Leaf Wraps

SHELLFISH (dried shrimp)

FISH (fish sauce, shrimp paste)

NUTS (peanuts)

Gai Hor Bai Toey –
Pandan Chicken

POULTRY

FISH (oyster sauce)

SESAME

GLUTEN (oyster/soy sauce)

Pad Thai – Rice
Noodles

SHELLFISH (shrimp)

FISH (fish sauce, dried shrimp)

EGGS

NUTS (peanuts)

Gaeng Keow Wan –
Green Curry

POULTRY

FISH (fish sauce, shrimp paste)

SHELLFISH (shrimp paste)

Massaman Neua – Beef
Curry

BEEF

FISH (fish sauce, shrimp paste)

NUTS (peanuts)

Pad Kra Pao – Basil
Pork

PORK

FISH (fish sauce)

EGGS

GLUTEN (oyster/soy)

Khao Man Gai –
Poached Chicken Rice

POULTRY

FISH (soy sauce)

SESAME

GLUTEN (soy)

Tom Kha Gai –
Coconut Soup

POULTRY

FISH (fish sauce)

Pad See Ew – Stir-
Fried Noodles

POULTRY

EGGS

FISH (oyster sauce)

GLUTEN (soy)

Khao Pad – Thai
Fried Rice

EGGS

FISH (fish sauce)

GLUTEN (soy)

Mango Sticky Rice

TREE NUTS (coconut)

SESAME

Tub Tim Grob – Water
Chestnuts

TREE NUTS (coconut)

Kluay Tod – Fried
Banana

GLUTEN (rice flour batter)

TREE NUTS (coconut)

SESAME

DAIRY (coconut ice cream – confirm supplier)